

QMS SOP TEMPLATE:

CAPA Management

Quality
Management
System
Standard
Operating
Procedure



QMS SOP TEMPLATE: **CAPA** **Management**

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Introduction

CAPAs and Continuous Improvement using Process Performance and Product Quality Monitoring (PPPQMS) are elements of a Quality System.

Having a system for implementing corrections, corrective and preventive actions resulting from the investigations, can facilitate how underlying root cause(s) are addressed to prevent recurrence, or how to minimize or eliminate occurrence of a potential problem or a non-conformance.

By defining effective CAPAs and PPPQMS, a Quality System can be monitored and improved.

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1.0 Purpose

The purpose of this procedure is to describe the methodology behind formulating, implementing, and monitoring of CAPAs to ensure continual improvement and compliance with applicable regulations.

2.0 Scope

This procedure applies to all Corrections, Corrective and Preventive Actions as well as mitigating actions.

The requirements of this Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) do not include remedial, corrective, or preventive actions related to Safety. The Safety Program is monitored by the Environmental, Health and Safety (EH&S) systems.

3.0 Definitions/Abbreviations

Action: A quality record that is initiated as a Correction, Corrective, Preventive or Mitigation Action

CAPA Program: A system for implementing corrections, corrective and preventive actions resulting from the investigation of complaints, product rejections, non-conformances, recalls, deviations to address the underlying root cause to prevent recurrence, or to minimize or eliminate occurrence of a potential problem or a non-conformance.

Cross-Functional Investigation: An investigation that requires individuals from various departments for input and impact assessment of the deviation. The team should consist of subject matter experts representing departments impacted by the deviation, and at a minimum should include personnel from QA and the investigating department.

PPQMS: Process Performance and Product Quality Monitoring System.

Root Cause: The cause that, if corrected, will prevent recurrence of a deviation or non-conformance as well as similar occurrences. A root cause is the most fundamental aspect of the cause that can be logically identified or corrected.

SMART: Specific, Measurable, Acceptable, Realistic, Timebound

4.0 Responsibilities

Assigned to: Ensures that assigned actions are implemented and driven to closure by the established due date and provide documented evidence that the action has been completed.

CAPA Coordinator: Administers the CAPA program, including initiating Actions and tracking timelines, organizes meetings on investigations, summarizes information. Determines the need for an Effectiveness Check (EC) for Corrections, Corrective and Preventive Actions prior to initiation.

Department Manager or designee: Review action assigned to direct reports prior to implementation. Assist in resource allocation to ensure Actions are completed by the due date.

5.0 Requirements

- CAPA Form
- CAPA Log

6.0 Risks/Points of Attention

Insufficient Root Cause Analysis can lead to ineffective or wrongly defined CAPAs.

Any CAPA can add benefits and/or have negative consequences. It is important to review CAPAs after implementation, not only for effectiveness, but also to understand and document these unexpected consequences.

Even though a due date set will be set for performance of CAPAs, the “quick wins” should be performed as soon as possible.

When the amount of CAPAs defined approaches a level that the organization might not be able to manage in the near future, a review of all outstanding CAPAs is organized, attended by Upper Management, for:

- **Low Hanging Fruit:** What can we do to remove frequently recurring situations that consume many resources?
- **Obsolescence:** have other situations changed so that the CAPA is not serving the (same) goal anymore?
- **Value Proposition:** Is this the most effective and efficient way to currently solve the problem?
- **Current Strategies and Projects:** Are these CAPAs still in line with our strategies? Or can CAPAs be combined with other projects?
- **Urgency for implementation:** Do we need to do this now? If other measures are implemented, is it possible to postpone?

This meeting and its outcomes will be fully documented and a new strategic CAPA plan will be generated and approved by Upper Management.

7.0 Summary/Flowchart

7.1 After an event has occurred, CAPAs can be initiated at any moment to:

- Stop further harm being done
- Prevent the situation from getting worse
- Prevent this specific event or similar events from happening (again)

7.2 A Change Control may be required to execute the CAPA

7.3 The CAPA is formulated using SMART principles

7.4 After executing the CAPA, an effectiveness verification may need to take place.

8.0 Procedure

8.1 All events require investigation and root cause analysis before entering the CAPA system.

8.2 There are four (4) types of CAPA defined that can be initiated at any moment:

8.2.1 Correction: Stop the event from happening

8.2.2 Corrective Actions: Prevent the event from happening again

8.2.3 Preventive Actions: Prevent similar events at other locations from happening

8.2.4 Mitigation Action: Use Risk Analysis to identify possible situations where a similar problem could occur and prevent these events from happening

8.3 More complicated CAPAs, that will change GMP processes or procedures, require Change Control (see SOP Change Control) before implementation.

These more complex CAPAs should be identified on the basis of an Investigation into the root cause of a Quality Event and subsequent Risk Analysis.

8.4 CAPAs should be formulated using the SMART principles:

- Specific
- Measurable
- Acceptable
- Realistic
- Timebound

8.5 CAPA effectiveness should be monitored directly after the event:

- To ensure the problem has been solved
- To detect any possible positive and negative side effects

After a certain period of time, depending on the type of CAPA, further evaluation of the CAPA may take place, including for possible additional side effects.

9.0 Documentation of Results

- CAPAs are documented on a CAPA Form
- All CAPA numbers are kept in a CAPA Log
- If a Change Control is required, the Change is documented on a Change Control Form.

10.0 References

- ISPE APQ Guide Corrective Action and Preventive Action (CAPA) System
- 21 CFR Part 820 – Quality System Regulation (for Medical Devices)
 - 21 CFR Part 820.100 – Corrective and Preventive Action.
- 21 CFR Part 210 – Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, Packing, or Holding of Drugs; General
- FDA 21 CFR Part 211 – Current Good Manufacturing Practice for Finished Pharmaceuticals
- EU GMP Guide – Part I: Chapter 1 (Pharmaceutical Quality System)
- Pharmaceutical Inspection Co-operation Scheme. *PIC/S Guide to Good Manufacturing Practice for Medicinal Products: Part I (PE 009-17)*
- TRS 986 – Annex 2: WHO Good Manufacturing Practices for Pharmaceutical Products: Main Principles

11.0 Revision History

- Rev 01 – Initial release
- Rev 02 – [To be updated with future changes]

12.0 Addenda

12.1 Addendum I: CAPA Types Example

Event: Returning after lunch an employee notices that the floor of the warehouse has standing water. Someone turned on the tap, forgot to close it, and since the sink was clogged the water started filling the basin and overflowed.

CAPA Type	Definition	Example
Correction	Stop the event from happening	Close the tap
Correcting Actions	Control the damage done	Start mopping the floor
Corrective Actions	Prevent the event from happening again	Implement a tap with a foot pedal Unclog the sink
Preventive Actions:	Prevent similar events at other locations from happening	Implement taps with foot pedals everywhere. Add regular deep cleaning of sinks to cleaning programs
Mitigation Actions	Use Risk Analysis to identify possible situations where a similar problem could occur and prohibit these events from happening	Look at all items that need human interaction to “close” (e.g., doors, computers, lights, heating) Identify the most critical ones and automate “closing” (e.g., door closers, screen locks after 5 min)

12.2 Addendum II: CAPA Form Example

CAPA Number: 24 555	Related to: I – 24231 & D – 12345	
Date CAPA Initiated:	Date: 30 NOV 2024	By: JEME
Date CAPA Completion Due:	Date: 15 MAR 2025	By: JEME
Description of CAPA	Perform an audit on PackyTack for insect infestation of packaging material	
Reference to Change Control? (Yes / No)	If No, please explain:	
Attachments (Yes / No)	List attachments	
Further follow-up for verification required: (Yes / No)	If yes, please describe, including timelines for multiple follow-up. If no, provide justification.	
CAPA Owner’s name: J. Menno	Date: 30 NOV 2024	Signature: JMenno
Review CAPA Coordinator	Date: 01 DEC 2024	By: PEPE
CAPA Complete (incl. first review)	Date: 03 FEB 2025	By: JEME
Another CAPA Review required? Yes / No	Date: 03 FEB 2025	By: PEPE
Review CAPA Coordinator	Date: 03 FEB 2025	By: PEPE



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